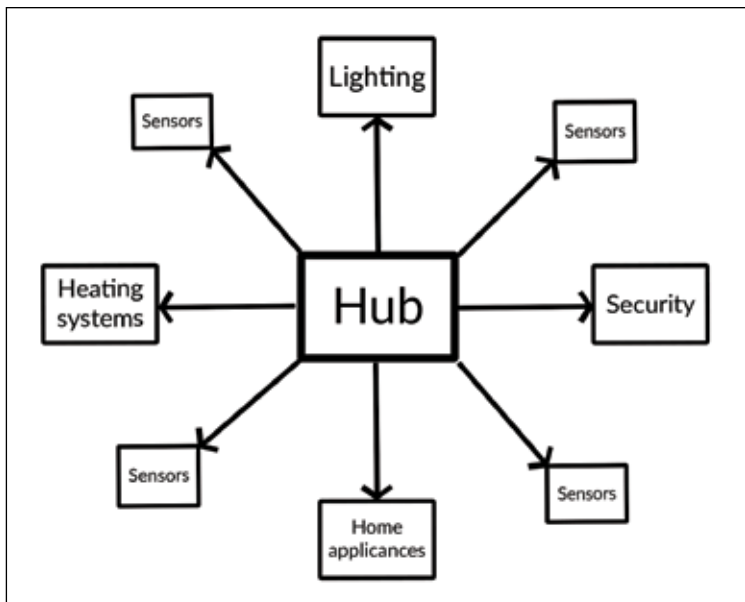


It doesn't take a genius to figure out what home automation entails: it's pretty much just the usage of smartphones and other easily available computing devices to automate and control household items and devices – from electrical appliances to lights to doors – with the help of hardware that can be controlled remotely.

Most home automation begins small – people start with controlling simple binary devices, that could either be in an 'on' or 'off' state. But it's when these devices are hooked up to the internet that they become truly smart and enter the realm of the Internet of Things. In fact, most automation systems nowadays use their Internet-enabled abilities to record and analyse usage patterns of devices, mostly lighting and heating systems, to reduce monthly electricity bills and overall energy expenditure.

While setting up a home automation system, the best place to start investing in is your personal nuisances. For many people, the most obvious problem is their electricity bill, so most people purchase a few smart lights as their first home automation product. Or if you're the kind of person who's constantly paranoid about whether they left the geyser on, smart switches would ease your paranoia. From there, you slowly build up a



A home automation system